

Astra 6700	AstraSlim 600	AstraSlim 1200
2400 x 4800	600 x 1200	1200 X 2400
19200	9600	9600
48	36	36
USB 2.0	USB	USB
✓	✗	✗
4	3	4
Scan to Mail, Copy, Direct scan	None	None
Standard*	Standard*	Standard*, no OCR software
44.60	23.00	19.28
19.28	28.67	33.10
333.79	87.79	92.62
20.98	93.49	78.07
2699.30	673.98	949.88
22	20	20
22	20	20
3	0	1
3	0	0
2	2	1
2	2	1
3	3	2
3	3	3
2	4	4
3	3	3
2	2	4
1	1	14
21	21	21
20	20	20
1	1	1
35.98	66.59	50.74
36.61	71.62	59.14
54.50	64.84	67.65
42.36	67.68	59.18
		
Neoteric	Neoteric	Neoteric
022-24172600	022-24172600	022-24172600
sales@ neoteric-info.com	sales@ neoteric-info.com	sales@ neoteric-info.com
15,950	3,900	6,950

⁺RTB: Return to Base ⁺⁺ULR: Unit Level Replacement

Buying Tips



- Select a hardware resolution depending upon the kind of document you are going to scan, e.g. 600 dpi is not enough if you are planning to scan photographs.
- Check out the packaging contents and make sure that the requisite cables and connectors are bundled along with the scanner.
- Check whether the vendor gives carry-in or on-site warranty. On-site warranty is a better option as the technician comes to your place for repairs.
- A Transparency Adapter is a must if you are going to scan negatives. Also ensure that the scanner has an interface to connect the required adapter.
- New scanners might have thermocol bits on their inner sides that may produce black dots on the media scanned. Remove such particles from the scanner by wiping it with a soft cloth and make sure there are no scratches on the glass surface.
- If you are scanning thick books or such, opt for a scanner with a removable lid or one where the lid can rise to a height of 2 inches and more.
- 36-bit scanners are on their way out, 48-bit is now considered to be the entry-level for scanners. Therefore, buy one with 48-bit colour depth.
- A good OCR and imaging software bundled along with the scanner will not only save you the additional investment, but also extend the usability of your scanner.

scan, e-mail and print directly, and it makes a perfect companion for your workstation.

In the OCR test, the scanner which blew us away with its accuracy, was the Umax Astra 2500. It scanned the test image at 200 dpi in full colour mode so impressively that ABBYY FineReader 6.0CE, the OCR software used, read each and every character precisely. The software was also able to pick up letters which were in another font. That this accuracy was achieved on a newspaper clip, makes it an even more impressive feat. The only thing that we missed in this scanner, was an Automatic Document Feeder. Available for Rs 3,950, this scanner scored a respectable 86.56 STTI.

Even the HP Scanjet 3500c performed adequately in this test—just the character ‘P’ was wrongly recognized as ‘R’ in one instance. This machine also performed well in the quality tests, and the three hot keys added to its capabilities. The 3500c has a total of three connectors: one each for a USB interface, power adapter and a Transparency Material Adapter (TMA). This makes the scanner ready for negative scanning, but you would need to shell out Rs 3,000 to Rs 4,000 extra for such a function. The 3500c is available for Rs 7,099 and easily scans documents at 1200 dpi. Its STTI is 77.69, making it a worthy buy for overall office use.

The HP Scanjet 3500c is available for Rs 7,099 but the 1200 dpi scanner with the option for TMA is more suited for photographers and imaging professionals. This scanner managed the STTI score of 77.69. However, the Umax Astra 4700 scored 78.76 STTI—even though it fell out of the price band by Rs 700—making it the best performer to cost in the vicinity of Rs 11,000. This was achieved because of its better performance in the speed test, the OCR test and a good-enough showing in the quality test. Although the scanner is light on features, it manages to use every component to its fullest, making it a good buy for day-to-day office use.

We recommend the Umax Astra 2500. At a price of Rs 3,950, even without shortcut keys, this scanner immensely impressed us.